



Examination Report

Siswati as a Second
Language

6871

EGCSE

2025

Table of Content

Code	Subject Name and Component	Page#
6871	SiSwati as a Second Language P1	3 - 9
6871	SiSwati as a Second Language P2	10 - 16
6871	SiSwati as a Second Language P3	17 - 20

Paper 6871/01
Reading and Directed Writing

Key messages

- Candidates should make sure they read the paper carefully, looking at the key words, to answer the set of questions.
- In Umsebenti 1, candidates were assessed on whether they were able to convey information and express opinions effectively. Candidates must read the given comprehensions and questions carefully before responding to the question. They should make sure that they understand what they are being asked, and that where possible all parts of questions are addressed. In Umsebenti 2, candidates were assessed on where they had read and able to comprehend and be able to identify a statement uttered by a particular speaker.
- Umsebenti 3 required candidates to comprehend and write notes under specific given sub-headings. Umsebenti 4 is a summary question. Candidates were expected to write in continuous prose and in one paragraph rather than in bullets. The candidates need to focus on the question and use their own words as much as possible or clearly paraphrase or synthesise the words in the comprehension.
- Umsebenti 5 was a composition writing. Candidates were expected to write a diary. Stimulus material for the composition topics provides guidance for the candidates to engage with the topic. In Umsebenti 6, candidates were to write an argumentative composition. Stimulus material for the composition topics guides for the candidates to engage with the topic. Candidates should then be encouraged to use this. However, essays, which draw only on this material and do not contain any other material that the candidates have contributed are limited in their scope and are marked accordingly.

General Comments

The work seen by examiners in this series was indeed of a variable quality, with several candidates achieving higher levels whilst a remarkable number of candidates struggled to achieve good grades. There are indications that very few centres have not fully embraced all that the subject entails.

This paper consists of six different exercises, which are of different lengths, and skills candidates need to apply. Candidates were assessed on whether they were able to convey information and express opinions effectively.

The overall performance was above average. However, few candidates were able to score far below average, and some did not perform well in few questions. These were some parts of Umsebenti 1, Umsebenti 4, Umsebenti 5 and Umsebenti 6. That greatly affected most candidates. Those who scored below average lacked reading, understanding and writing skills. Some candidates had challenges concerning distinguishing

the types of essay writing. For instance, in Umsebenti 5, candidates were expected to write a diary, but to lack of understanding of key words or rather phrases in the question, few opted for a dialogue and a letter which saw them getting low marks. Question 6 required them to write an argumentative composition. Few candidates displayed well understanding of what writing an argumentative composition entail. Most candidates did not do very well.

Comments on Specific Questions

Umsebenti 1 is marked out of ten marks. It was mainly aimed at assessing candidates on their ability to read, comprehend and respond on a text about weaning a baby, giving details on what and when a mother stop breastfeeding should. Most candidates were able to score above average on this item, however, there were very few cases where candidates missed the points and that proved to be a lack of understand of what the text all was about, maybe also less understanding of siSwati. However, most candidates understood and responded well on the questions asked.

(a) Kufanele alimunye sikhatsi lesinganani libele umntfwana?

[1]

Expected answer:

- **Iminyaka lemibili**

This item was aimed at finding out for how long a baby should be breastfed. Few candidates were able to identify the required answer. For a candidate to score a mark were to provide the answer written in bold above. Almost all the candidates were able to identify the answer. However, very few did not get it right for lacked understanding of the language.

(b) Nika kubili lokungaba yingoti kumntfwana longamunyi.

[1]

Expected answer:

- **Kungakheki kahle kwemtimba¹nekungenwa kalula tifo¹.**

This item was aimed at finding out the dangers of a baby that is not breastfed. This required candidates to write the response eluded in bold above. The expected response is written on the bullet above. For one to score both marks, were to give the above responses. Most candidates were able to score a mark. Those candidates who did not score both points were those who wrote what the baby could do if not breastfed thus giving such an answer, "**angabese uyalidvubalibele**", instead of stating the consequences. Some lacked understanding of the language.

(c) Bhala bumcoka bekumunyisa lokungenani tinyanga letisitfupha? [1]

Expected answer:

- **Kusita umntfwana angangenwa tifo kalula.**

Most candidates did score on this item. Maybe it could be the knowledge they have. Only the response written in the bullet above enabled candidates to score full marks. Most seemed to understand what the question required for they responded with the right response. Those that failed wrote the wrong answer like, "Kusita kutsi acine emtimbeni," which they were wrong. This could be lack of understanding of the language.

(d) Chaza lamagama lalandzelako:

(i) Sekateka tonkhe tindzaba [1]

Expected answer:

- **Sewutakhuluma**

(ii) Asigcala [1]

Expected answer:

- **Kuba bete lubisi lwekumunyisa.**

Item (i) was well answered, and this could be prior knowledge. However, a very few did not get it right and this could be lack of understanding of the language. The question required the candidates to explain the meaning of *sekateka tonkhe tindzaba*. Most candidates were able to write the general knowledge than answering using the information given in the text. However, what they elaborated was correct, like *sekacoca*, *akhuluma tonkhe tindzaba*. Item (ii) most candidate could not get it right, and this could be the language barrier, whereas it was explained clearly in the text. They would give responses like *longakhoni kumunyisa* instead of the answer alluded above in the second bullet. Candidates were expected to respond as the response given in the bullets above. Some manage to give only one response thus resulting in them not scoring both points. For candidates to score both marks, they were to write two of the responses expected. Those who responded well responded as listed on the bullets.

(e) Chaza kutsi isetjentiselwani inhlaba nakulunyulwa umntfwana. [2]

Expected answer:

- **Inhlaba iyababa¹ itawumenta alesabe noma ngabe uyalihawukela¹.**

This item proved to be a not so difficult question, but it was to some candidates who failed to use higher order thinking. The question required the candidates to explain why aloe is used in weaning a baby. They were to give two supporting statements. Some were able to come out with only one supporting statement whereas those that lacked good understanding of the language scored nothing.

A very few candidates got it right. The few that wrote the expected response could be those who displayed good understanding of the language and have a knowledge what “inhlaba” is and how it tastes. Those who got it right were able to site at least two of the answers listed above.

(f) Kuhle kutsi umntfwana agcine alunyuliwe ebeleni. Sekela lombono.

[2]

Expected answers:

- **Make wemntfwana uyakhululeka/aphumule¹ angahlushwa ngumntfwana ebusuku¹ / make angakhona kulamisa.¹**

This item proved to be an easy one for most candidates were able to get it right. Most candidates were unable to score all the marks. A very few candidates scored one point. Those that did not get anything were those that lack understanding of the language. For candidates to score all the two marks, they were to provide responses alluded in the bullets above. The question required the candidates to support the statement given. Those candidates who lacked good understanding of the language scored nothing. To get all the marks, they were to give at least two of the responses alluded in the bullets above.

Umsebenti 2

This exercise was based on a detailed reading comprehension where speakers give their different views on bags. Candidates were to write and match statements with some letters given to each speaker.

Expected responses

- | | |
|--|----------|
| (a) Loveta kutsi sikhwama unikwa ngumnikati waso. | C |
| (b) Lotsi sikhwama sihambelana nekugcoka kwemuntfu. | A |
| (c) Loveta kutsi sikhwama sivikela kulahlekelwa tintfo. | D |
| (d) Lotsi sikhwama ngumuntfu logcina timali. | B |
| (e) Logcizelela kutsi sikhwama siyaphilisa. | C |
| (f) Lonembono lotsi sikhwama ulusito etinhlanganweni. | B |
| (g) Locabanga kutsi kuphatsa sikhwamakunebungoti. | D |
| (h) Lochaza kutsi sikhwama siyasita kutsi ukhone kutilungisa endleleni. | A |

This question proved easy for most of the candidates did well. Some candidates could have maybe used guesswork due to lack of understanding the language. Most scored all the points. This then contributed positively to the overall performance. What was worth noting was that most candidates managed to score above fifty percent.

Exercise 3

In this exercise, candidates were required to engage in a note-making task under the given subheadings. The candidates were to read a text about the paying allegiance to the king (*kuhlehla*). Most candidates perform well in this question for they proved too able to write notes. However, some wrote sentences instead of writing notes and this was detrimental their performance on this. Also, they relied on the little knowledge they had about paying allegiance to the king other than using the information provided by the text as this was a reading comprehension. However, on average it was fairly done though not so good, they managed to score at least five points. Only a few candidates got nothing.

(a) Bumcoka bekuhlehla

Expected answers:

- **Kufundzisa inhlonipho** [1]
- **Emabutfo atfola litfuba lekwatana nekufundzisana ngemphilo** [1]
- **Kuhlanganisa sive nemakhosi** [1]

Candidates were to provide three of the expected answers to obtain the three marks. Most candidate scored a mark or two instead of the three marks.

(b) Umsebenti wekudla lokulinywa emphakatsi

Expected answers:

- **Kusebenta nakunemcimbi** [1]
- **Kondla tihambi netintsandzane** [1]

Candidates were supposed to write about use of the food that is cultivated at the royal kraal. This proved to be difficult for most candidates did not get it right. These could be those without a proper understanding of siSwati. However, a few were able to give the answers written on the above bullets. Most got all the two responses.

(c) Tizatfu tekungahlehli

- **Kusebenta** [1]
- **Buvila** [1]
- **Yinkholo** [1]

This item proved to be accessible. However, a struggle for most candidates who have little understanding of the language was evident. Expected responses are listed on the above bullets. Most candidates scored all the three marks. Candidates were required to write reasons why people do not pay allegiance to the king or the chief. The expected responses are the above on the bullets, quite a few candidates were able to attempt

to the question and gave the expected responses, which made them score at all the marks. This exercise also proved that some candidates still lacked the skill of writing notes.

Umsebenti 4

This was a summary task where candidates were giving task to read a text, about trash. This exercise has 12 marks of which 9 marks were for the content, and 4 marks were for language usage, correct spelling and correct skill for writing a summary. This question required the candidates to write up a summary on what could be done to minimize trash. The summary should have 80 – 90 words only. A few candidates wrote more than 90 words of which most points fell after the 90th word and no marks were given for that. Some candidate would write as little words as 50, of which that made them not to write all the points. Generally, it was not a well-performed question, most candidates scored below average. Most candidates could not identify the points for answering the question. Some candidates failed to understand the question. Some lacked the skill of writing a summary for they wrote it in paragraphs instead of writing one continuous paragraph. A few did not attempt the question at all, and this could be lack of understanding. Very few candidates were able to come up with all the main points, but a little number of them scored above average, some scored nothing and those did not comply with the instruction and mostly copied the exact words from the text instead of paraphrasing using their own words thus leading into not getting the full marks for language. A very few opted to write only points instead of writing a paragraph which should be in a prose form. However, this made them not to get all the 9 marks for points and getting nothing for language.

Expected responses were as follows:

Sifinyeto ngetintfo letingentiwa kugcina lulwimi lwemdzabu.

- Lahla tibi emgconyeni / landzela tindlela tekulahla tibi.
- Sebentisa liplastiki lelizala kunekutsenga lelisha.
- Sebentisa sikhwama sekuphatsa.
- Akube nemigcoma yekulahla tibi emadolobheni.
- Asingabutsisi tintfo lesingatisebentisi.
- Emakhaya akube nemigodzi yekulahla tibi.
- Akufundziswe ngebumcoka bekulahla kahle tibi.
- Hlukanisa tibi ngetinhlobo tato.
- Mikisa tibi lapho titsengiswa khona/yakha letinye tintfo ngetibi.
- Sebentisa kwakha manyolo.

Candidates, who did well, understood the question, were able to identify relevant points, and followed the right procedure of writing a summary. Some candidates did not even identify the points. Those candidates who did not score well were those that did not write the things that can be done to prevent the spread/ minimize thrash.

Umsebenti 5

Esikolweni sakho benineluhambo lwelilanga linye lwekufundza loluya etindzweni letehlukene. Indzawo lenigcine ngayo kuyivakashela kuseMlilwane lapho kugcinwa khona tilwane tasendle.

Bhala idayari yelusuku. Idayari yakho ayibe ngemagama langu 150–200. [16]

This exercise required the candidates to write a diary. It was marked out of sixteen (16). Mark bands were used as a criterion for scoring the candidates. Candidates were expected to write a diary for one day. Few candidates performed the required task quite well. However, most points were not well developed thus ending up scoring lower marks. It is a requirement that when writing a diary for one day should be separated by the times. The date should be written once at the beginning. Some candidates wrote a letter, and others wrote a dialogue of which that led them not to get good marks. Some decided to write a diary for more than one day. In addition, those that do not have a good command of the language were disadvantaged. Some did not attempt writing the question.

Umsebenti 6

Kugcokwa kwenyufomu etikolweni kulusito kubafundzi nebatali.

Bhala indzabamphikiswano uvete umuvo wakho ngekugcokwa kwenyufomu bafundzi etikolweni. Indzaba yakho ayibe ngemagama langu 150–200. [16]

This was the most challenging exercise in the whole examination and across many centres. It greatly affected the performance of the candidates as it carried a lot of weight, which is sixteen (16) marks. Mark bands were used when assessing the candidates. Few candidates did not attempt the question, and this could be that they did not have a good command of the language and maybe they did not understand the task. Candidates were expected to write an argumentative composition on the wearing of uniforms in schools. However, some lacked the skill of writing this type of composition. Some candidates were able to write but could not develop the points well. A very few candidates ascertain what was expected of them. Few wrote narrative compositions and a very few did not attempt the question.

**Paper 6871/02
Listening**

Key messages

- Candidates should carefully read the questions during the given time.
- Umsebenti 1 comprised of a series of five comprehension items based on a series of short-spoken texts or passages, candidates were expected to respond in either one-word, short phrases or even sentences.
- Umsebenti 2 was a comprehension exercise based on a longer spoken text requiring the candidates' completion of gaps. Questions in this exercise had leads and examples.
- In Umsebenti 3, candidates were expected to listen to seven short extracts in which different speakers give their views on games.
- Umsebenti 4 comprehension exercise based on longer spoken texts. Candidates were required to complete gaps in sentences.
- Umsebenti 5 was a comprehension exercise based on a longer text where candidates were required to answer using phrases or sentence-length answers.

General comments

This part of the examination aimed at assessing candidates' ability to listen to recorded texts of varying lengths and respond to them effectively. It had five different exercises. Such texts can either be recorded dialogues, interviews, conversations, talks, and many more. Candidates in this part of the examination did not perform well. Many of them scored above average with very few performing below average. The general performance was above average. However, it was noted that question 3 was a bit very easy for most of the candidates; they were guessing the responses instead of listening attentively. This then ended up having many candidates scoring at least four out of seven, particularly in this question.

The overall performance was above average in this paper, with very few candidates scoring below average. Those that scored below average could be those who lack full understanding of the language.

Umsebenti 1

This part of the examination featured short passages and dialogues whereby candidates were expected to respond in one either word, short phrases or even sentences. It carried five (5) marks with each passage carrying one mark. Most candidates scored above average. However, there were very few who scored below average.

(a) Yini lekufanele sikucaphele uma sijuba tihlahla nasinikwe indzawo yekwakha? [1]

Expected response:

- **Kucaphela kutsi singajubi tihlahla tonkhe.**

Candidates were required to write what someone should be aware of when given a piece of land to build a home. The expected answer is written on the above bullet. A very few candidates never scored a mark and wrote only that we should cut down trees whereas the gist was in not cutting all the trees. Those candidates proved to be those with little understanding of the language.

(b) Liphopho likusita uma kwentenjani? [1]

Expected response

- **Uma usongekile**

This proved to be an easily accessible item to most candidates. However, some candidates did write correct responses. The question required them to state when pawpaw helps one. Candidates who were awarded a mark wrote the above bulleted response. However, some only wrote '*uma ubulawa sisu*' and these were not awarded a point whereas those that wrote, '*uma unekusongeka esiswini*' were awarded. Those The correct one should be the one written above in the bullet.

(c) Lokhulumako ufuna kutsengelwa ini? [1]

Expected response:

- **Emajobo**

This proved to be a tricky item. The question required the candidates to mention what the speaker wanted them to buy for him. Most of those who did not get a point are those that wrote '*sidvwashi*' and those would be the candidates who had little or no understanding of the language.

(d) Wetfuswa yini Thando? [1]

Expected response:

- **Kunebantfu labagcwele egedeni / bantfu belubalo.**

This item proved to be a challenging one for most candidates did not score a mark on it. The question required the candidates to state what was scaring Thando. There were very few cases where the candidates got a

mark whereas they wrote '*bantfu labagcoke tikipla letimhlophe egedeni.*' Most of the candidates proved not to be able to comprehend well for the text said Thando fears the people who were doing census at the gate. Few did not score a point on this item. Those could be those with little understanding of the language. Those that were able to come up with the right information wrote the above point on bullet. Most candidates got it right.

(e) Yini lokubangela bantfu bangakhoni kuya etindzaweni tekujima?

[1]

Expected response:

- **Letindzawo tiyadula / kuba bete imali**

This item proved to be somewhat difficult for most candidates did not get it right. The candidate who wrote '*bacabanga kutsi kufuneka timali letinyenti / letinkhulu*' were marked wrong for this was a listening comprehension exercise and the correct answer should what they had heard. However, most candidates scored a point on this item.

Umsebenzi 2

In this exercise candidates were expected to fill in gaps after listening to a talk about a how to choose subjects. Most candidates scored above average and this then made the performance on this exercise a good one. Candidates were giving precise answers to the questions. However, few cases were below average. It was noted though that some candidates had problems maybe with listening. However, there were very few cases where candidates could not write the correct answer, and this could be caused by a lack of good command of the language and lacking good foundation of the language.

The expected responses were as follows:

Expected responses:

- (a)** Kufanele nati kutsi akusito tonkhe tifundvo letikhona **letitowentiwa** nguwo wonkhe umfundzi. **[1]**
- (b)** Sinetifundvo **letine** letitawentiwa nguwo wonkhe umfundzi. **[1]**
- (c)** Uma sekukhetfwa tifundvo bantfu batsatfwa **ngumdvumo** noma babuke kutsi ngubani lofundzisa leso sifundvo. **[1]**
- (d)** Yenta siciniseko kutsi leso sifundvo sihambelana nesiphiwo sakho. **[1]**
- (e)** Uma ufuna kuba **ngusomabhizinisi** kufanele ukhetse sifundvo semabhizinisi. **[1]**
- (f)** Tinike sikhatsi wente **luphenyo** kubongcondvomshini **ngemakhono** labafunekako. **[2]**
- (g)** Anifuni kucedza **kufundzele** bese nitikhandza nihleti. **[1]**

Umsebenti 3

In this exercise, candidates were expected to listen to seven short extracts about games. Candidates will choose from the list A to H, which opinion each speaker expresses. It was noted though that the candidates did not get enough practice. However, the exercise proved to be particularly easy. Only a few candidates scored low marks. It is and then suggested that candidates be given as much practice as they can.

	Expected responses
(a) Sikhulumi 1	H
(b) Sikhulumi 2	C
(c) Sikhulumi 3	G
(d) Sikhulumi 4	A
(e) Sikhulumi 5	D
(f) Sikhulumi 6	E
(g) Sikhulumi 7	B

Umsebenti 4

In this exercise, candidates were to listen to a dialogue between Mr Mamba and Wandile about opening an account at the bank. Candidates were to fill in blank spaces. This indicated that candidates were able to follow the conversation, but most could not comprehend very well what was said.

(a) Lamuhla esikolweni besivakashelwe libhange le [1]

Expected response:

- **sakhiwo**

This item was well done for most candidates wrote the required response. However, those that lack good command of the language could not get it right. Generally, candidates performed well.

(b) Batsi asivule ebhange khona sitocala kubeka imali yetfu. [1]

Expected response:

- **ema-akhawunti**

Most candidates were unable to come up with a correct response. Those that have little command of the language did not anything and those were very limited. Some of the candidates wrote '*emabhuku*' whereas in the text it was read as '*ema-akhawunti*.' They decided to use the knowledge they have than relying on the text. The anticipated answer was the one written in bold in the above sentence. This item proves to be very easy though for most candidates scored a point on it.

(c) Uma sewuyifuna awuyitfoli yonkhe ngoba phela emabhange uma uvule libhuku. [1]

Expected response:

- **ayabhadalisa.**

This item proved to be not an easy one, although few candidates did respond well. The expected answer is written in bold in the above sentence.

(d) Emabhange atsatsa timali tebantfu atsembise [1]

Expected response:

- **intalo lesetulu**

This item was friendly to the candidates. Most candidates wrote that the expected answer. For one to obtain a point, candidates were expected to write the words in bold in the above bullet. Very few candidates were unable to score a mark.

(e) Bekela kute nakufika simo emphilweni ukhone kuyotsatsa. [1]

- **ngephandle, lesimatima.¹**

This one also proved not to be friendly to the candidates for most of them did not score full marks. For candidates to score all the marks, they were to provide all the words written in bold above. Some only provided one response thus getting one point. Points were awarded as shown in the above bullet.

(f) Libhange yindzawo lekahle..... kubeka imali yakho. [1]

Expected response:

- **nalephephile**

This item proved to be a friendly one for most candidate scored a point. Those that did not understand the language did not score for they wrote wrong responses and some wrote nothing.

**(g) Imali ingandziswa ngekucala noma ifakwe etinkampaneni letinika
intalo [1]**

Expected responses:

- **ibhizinisi¹ lesetulu¹.**

The performance on this item was fair. Almost half of the candidates wrote the right responses. Those who were awarded a point are those that wrote the above response written in the bullet.

(h) Uma utawutsembeka kubeka lemali ngenyanga utakwengetela..... lemalangeni. [1]

Expected response:

likhulu

This was also not well done for a very few candidates were able to score a point.

All in all, this exercise proved not to be a friendly exercise. It proved to disadvantage the non-native speakers. This then affected the overall performance of the candidates both positively and negatively. Thus, most candidates scored below average.

Umsebenti 5

Candidates were expected to listen to a speech by Sibonelo, on how to mould clay pots. This exercise was based on a longer text. Candidates were required to answer with short answers, clauses and in sentences. This exercise proved to be not an accessible one to the candidates. Very few were able to score all the points. A lesser number were on average and a most scored below average and could be those with little or no understanding of the language. This exercise then contributed negatively to the overall performance of the candidates.

(a) Wafundzani Sibonelo uma avakashela kagogo? [1]

Expected response:

- **Kwakha tindziwo**

Candidates were expected to write the response alluded above in the bullet. Most candidates were able to score a point on this item.

(b) Yini sizatfu lesenta kutsi lolubumba lungagcwaliswa esakeni? [1]

Expected response:

- **Lolubumba luyasindza¹ kutawubese kuba lukhuni kulutfwala¹ (alutfwaleki)**

Most candidates did not provide a correct answer. The expected answer is given in the bullet above.

(c) Chaza bumcoka bekuhlanganisa lubumba. [2]

Expected response:

- **Kutsi lutsambe¹ lubete ematje¹.**

This item proved to be not easily accessible because most candidates did not score a point on this item.

(d) Luviwa kanjani kutsi ludziwo selomile?

[2]

Expected response:

- **Ulushaya ngesandla**

Most candidates scored on this item. For them to score they were to provide the answer written in the bullet above.

(e) Kungentekani uma tingete tingashiswa letindziwo?

[2]

Expected response:

- **Tingatsamba¹, utsi uma ufaka lokumanti lakuto tife¹ / angeke ticine kahle¹ futsi tingabhidlika¹.**

This was a tricky item for most candidates did not obtain a mark. Few candidates scored a point. Those that scored might be the ones with more understanding of the language. The right response is written in the bullet above.

(f) Tentiwani tindziwo uma setishisiwe?

[2]

Expected response:

- **Tibekwa tiphole¹ bese tigcotjiswa lunwali¹ (tilungele kutsengiswa)**

This item was somewhat not easy for most learners did not score. Few of the candidates were able to come up with a correct answer. Expected response is provided in the bullet above.

Finally, this part of the examination was well attended to. Most candidates scored way above average. Only a few scored below average and those are the candidates lacking good command of the language.

Paper 6871/03
Oral Assessment

Key messages

- At least five Oral Assessment Cards were issued, with an accompanying set of Teacher's Notes. Each card introduced a topic for discussion between the Teacher/Examiner and the candidate, together with suggestions for the development of the conversation. The introductory part was meant to at least give the candidate on what the topic is all about. Each candidate was to be examined using one Oral Assessment Card selected by the Teacher/Examiner from the range provided.
- Card A was about '*Mahlalekikhini*,' candidates were expected to come up with a lengthy discussion on the topic about pictures.
- Card B was '*Kugucugucuka kwesimo selitulu*,' candidates were expected to discuss anything pertaining games.
- Card C was based on '*Imfundvo*.' They were to develop a sustained discussion on the topic about internet.
- Card D was on '*Tivakashi*.' Candidates were to display their knowledge of what entails music, and in their conversations should have discussed anything pertaining music.
- Card E was a topic on security, '*Tifiso*.' Candidates were to converse lengthy on nature

General Comments

Candidates in this part of the examination are assessed on the structure of the language, their fluency and on vocabulary. This paper has thirty (30) marks, and it comprises of five (5) cards with different topics whereby candidates are tested on their ability to speak. Each candidate was given a duration of fifteen (15) minutes to finish the examination.

Most candidates displayed good command of the language as they were able to engage in a lengthy discussion without encountering any problems. Few candidates displayed lack of practice on this exercise, so instructors are urged to give candidates enough practice on this. It was evident that some candidates were doing an examination of this nature for the first time. Practise would help candidates to get used to such an examination.

It was also noted that some examiners tended to be very lenient when awarding marks instead of using the marking criteria presented in the marking scheme. For this reason, candidates ended up getting very high marks, which they did not deserve. It would then be a good thing for instructors to read the teacher's notes before conducting the examination for some instructors would not follow properly.

Examiners were able to submit all the necessary documents needed for this paper. However, few centres did not submit all the necessary documents. These documents are as follows: the mark sheet - MS1, which should have raw, scores not percentages. Scores are written as whole numbers, not in fractions. It is also advised that examiners use calculators to add the marks given in different categories. A great improvement on conducting the oral exam was also noted.

Almost all the centres did a very commendable job in this regard at least a very limited number of centres were called to the marking centre. Examiners are encouraged to listen to the USB before submitting them as some had disturbing noise from the background and some were not clearly audible. They are also advised to name the candidates using the candidates' number followed by the name as per the register. It is also recommended that when recording the exam only one file used. After the warmup the examiner should pause the recorder then continue with the conversation. It is recommended that examiners find a suitable place for conducting the examination.

Comments on conduction of examination

Examiners are commended for handling this examination in such an esteemed manner. They managed to create a friendly environment, which made candidates to be very relaxed. A few examiners, however, are still lacking in this regard. The cards were not fairly distributed that is there was a big difference in handing them all. The most handed cards were cards A, D and C. Card E was least distributed whereas card B was the least of them all.

Warm up:

Examiners are once again applauded on this part as they displayed a high level of professionalism when conducting this part of the examination. This is a stage whereby the examiner is expected to engage the candidates in a brief conversation. The candidate on the other hand will be expected to open up about him or herself in general so as be to detect his interest hence the examiner will hand out an appropriate card. However, a very few examiners are still lacking in this regard.

Hand Card: Preparation:

This part of the examination was also handled very well by the examiners. There were a few instances however, where examiners simply handed out the cards to the candidates without considering what inspired in their early conversation. This completely hindered the candidates' performance as it was apparent that they were not familiar with the contents of the card. Examiners are therefore urged to be attentive and note what transpired from this part of the examination to avoid giving out the card which the candidates will have very little to talk about.

Conversation:

Most candidates displayed very good communication skills in this part of the examination. They boldly engaged in fruitful conversation with their examiners. There were a few cases where candidates displayed a high level of nervousness to an extent of saying very little than expected. It should be noted that candidates need a lot of practice during the teaching and learning time. Such an examination should not come as a monster during the final examination. It is of paramount importance to note again, that these cards help both the examiner and the candidates towards engaging in the fruitful conversation. It should not be a presentation by candidates as it appeared in some cases. Also, additional information around the examiner may be thrown in here and there.

Some examiners tended to feature more in the conversation as opposed to the candidate who is being examined. As much as this was accepted for both parties to speak, it should also be noted that it was the candidate who was being examined not the examiner. The examiner had to balance the conversation between examinee and examiner.

Cards

Card A – Mahlalekhikhini

Most of the candidates who were handed this card seemed not to have any difficulty on how to define 'Mahlalekhikhini.' They were able to engage in a lengthy discussion. Weak candidates were those who lacked good vocabulary related on the topic thus displaying not well-developed conversation. They would give responses and wait for the examiner to prompt before saying anything. This card also proved to be one of the cards most handed.

Card B – Kugucugucuka kwesimo selitulu

The topic was about the changing weather. This was not a popular card; it was somehow difficult for some candidates. Some lacked details about the subject, hence, could not develop their presentations. Few candidates were handed this topic. Even those with good command of the language seemed to have some difficulties in talking about global warming. Those that did not have good command of the language were non-starters. Few candidates seemed to have enjoyed the topic. Those that have the language as a barrier were somehow disadvantaged though they knew what the topic was all about but could not express themselves in a very good and convincing manner.

Card C – Imfundvo

The topic was about education. This, however, was also a popular card. Many candidates found it hard to speak about education in general. The guiding statements were of great help to those that did not have good command of the language. However, in some instances, they still found it difficult to talk when even prompted

using the guiding points. Most candidates were able to sustain a conversation on this topic. However, were able to score good marks. The topic revealed the importance of education. Candidates were able to easily engage in lengthy conversations. Even those that were not native speakers of the language were able make fair attempt.

D – Tivakashi

This card also proved an easy card and was mostly handed out. The card required the candidates to converse on visitors. It was a very popular card though. Almost all the candidates that were handed this card displayed their understanding of visitors. They were able to engage in lengthy conversations. Candidates who were handed the card seemed to enjoy this topic. Some even went on to talk advantages and disadvantages of visitors. However, vocabulary on visitors was lacking thus most words used were in English. Some candidates would code switch. Some of conversations were very much interesting. In this topic, even those that did not have good command of the language were non-starters.

Card E – Tifiso

This card was not well distributed. The topic proved not to be an easy card. Candidates who were handed this card did not perform very well. Those that did well in this topic revealed good understanding of what entailed wishes entails and what is good about having wishes. They were able to discuss the different things that one can wish for. As the examiner prompted, they came up with good conversations.

Application of Assessment Criteria

It must be noted still that some centres were very good when awarding marks to candidates showing clearly that they followed their mark scheme thus a commendable act. Some centres, however, were too lenient or rather too severe thus a disadvantage to the candidates in both ways. Examiners should try to follow their mark schemes to avoid what has been mentioned earlier on. As much as it is acceptable for both parties to talk during the examination, one should play the role of being in the regard, as that will not crowd the examiner's judgement when awarding marks. It is also strongly advisable that the teachers' notes be used when conducting the oral examination.

It is recommended that candidates must be given enough practice in this oral session for it was evident that some Swazi speakers do speak siSwati and this could be that even at their respective homes the language is not used. Some even needed some assistance from the examiners in the interpreting of some siSwati words. The none-native speakers also should be given practise on this regard. This will help them improve in the angles they are lacking.

